



268 |

ing as soon as I started earning. I started investing at 24, after a year or two of starting to earn. I was working in the US then, so I used to invest in US mutual funds, equity mutual funds and international equity funds. My portfolio was largely equities. I started investing in Indian mutual funds shortly after I moved back here in 2009. I was 26, and while I had little experience managing money, I was clear about building a corpus. The corpus gave me the ability to move back from the US to India and start my own business without family backing, and with the confidence that I could ride out two to three years without a substantial income.

I am consistent with my equity holdings. My debt allocation has reduced in the overall portfolio from 35 per cent to 20 per cent at present. I have SIPs in some international funds as well. I don't have a large allocation in gold and silver. Currently, I don't do fixed income, and my debt portion is taken care of by my hybrid funds.

Q: How do you plan to invest, spend and save in the next decade?

NK: I believe that the asset classes are overpriced today. So, my exposure to gold and fixed income is high, and together they make up as much as 65 per cent of the portfolio. The idea is to wait for some reckoning/

‘Traditionally people believe in income minus expenses equal to savings. For some time, I have believed that income minus savings should be equal to expenses’

NILESH SHAH MD, KOTAK MAHINDRA ASSET MANAGEMENT COMPANY